

sit in the park and read books. If you're not careful, the townsfolk will become suspicious? Are you a communist or what?

You can handle the pressure, but what about Johnny? For his sake if not yours, you should try to make sure your family is accepted in the new town. Perhaps the quickest way to obtain acceptance is to spread money around. Give \$50 each to the local church, Boy Scout troop, United Crusade, and hospital. Your gifts say you may be wealthy, but you're sensitive to human needs. You should also volunteer your time. Remember, you're one of the few people with time to spare. Organize a school picnic, raise money for a new police car, serve as a volunteer fireman, play a part in the community theater's next project, and sell Christmas trees to help send kids to camp. You want to be visible and, most important, open about yourself. People suspect what they don't understand. Disarm them by unraveling the mystery of very early retirement. Tell them what you did before, why you retired, and why you moved to town. You and your way of life may become a topic of conversation. But by opening yourself to inspection, you'll make it easier for others to accept your decision—and for Johnny to get along in school.

SPECIFIC KNOWLEDGE

You'd like Johnny to get more out of school than the ability to get along with others. You want him to learn specific subjects as well: reading, writing, math, science, history, geography, civics. How do you check whether a school does a good job of imparting specific knowledge?

In my opinion, you can't. You're better off assuming that the local school does a *lousy* job of imparting specific knowledge.

I don't mean to dump on public schools in the South. A 15-year-old girl we know comes from a wealthy San Francisco family and goes to what I'm told is one of the best